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Dissertation Title: NAVIGATING THE COMPLEXITIES OF GLOBAL MARKET OPERATIONS: A STRATEGIC ANALYSIS OF THE INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS OPERATIONS AND RISK MANAGEMENT PRACTICES OF GSK (GLAXOSMITHKLINE)

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Author(s):	**Vishwa Murugesan**
Student ID(s):	**229058491**
Degree:	**Advanced Electrical & Electronic Engineering with Management MSc**
Project supervisor:	**Zeynel Abidin A. Cil**

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Abstract

In regards to this study, it comprehensively explores the international business operations as well as risk management practices of GSK; there, for the development of this subject, an interpretivist philosophy is employed along with explanatory design and inductive approach for analyzing the secondary qualitative data through thematic analysis. In this aspect, critical focus areas of this subject include market expansion strategies, impacts of global market dynamics, risk management strategies and regulatory compliance measures. There, the findings showcase the way the company GSK critically navigates diverse regulatory environments, mitigates operational risks as well as effectively expands into global markets at the same time. In this aspect, the study is responsible for providing comprehensive and valuable understanding the strategic position of GSK along with operational efficiency of the company that critically contributes towards the broader understanding of goal operations of multinational companies along with offering recommendations for the enhancement of practices within GSK in an dynamic and increasingly complex international landscape. .

Keywords: Complexities of global market operations, International business operations, Risk management practices, Global market operation etc.

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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

In the dynamic and rapidly evolving economy, multinational corporations face an intricate web of challenges along with opportunities at the time they expand their operations across diverse markets. The multinational company GSK (GlaxoSmithKline), is one of the most prominent leading players in the healthcare sector which epitomizes the complexities of effectively navigating the landscape of international business (Bhattacharyya and Naser, 2020). As the company with its operations spanning over more than 100 nations and in diverse sectors like vaccines, pharmaceuticals and consumer healthcare products, has to follow a range of distinct regulatory frameworks, competitive environment and market dynamics, which possess significant risks and challenges for the organization, along with that also demands effective and critical strategic approaches for maintaining their market competitiveness. Here, this study has provided a comprehensive understanding about the strategic approaches as well as risk management practices of the company by critically analyzing those considerations of GSK in their global operations. Now, through the exploration of market expansion strategies, regulatory compliance measures as well as impact of global market dynamics of the company on its competitive positioning as well as operational efficiency. Thus, they provide valuable insights into the effectiveness of the international business operations of GSK as well as the ability of the company to mitigate those associated risks and challenges. Regarding this, this section of the study provides a brief overview of the subject, along with that it also ensures the aim and objectives of the study, based on which the whole study is developed.

1.2 Research Background

The company GSK can be found is a global healthcare giant, the company has established itself as a critical and pivotal player in the international pharmaceutical sector, vaccine sector and consumer healthcare markets; there, the expansive global presence of GSK can be identified both a testament towards the success as well as source of ongoing challenge for the company. As suggested before, the company is operating over 100 nations, so it has to effectively navigate a complex array of regulatory environments, market dynamics as well as competitive landscapes, and all these factors demand a nuanced approach towards ensuring compliance, sustained

competitive advantages as well as operational efficiency (Reid *et al.* 2023). In this aspect, the pharmaceutical as well as the healthcare sectors' regulatory environment is specifically stringent as well as varies significantly across differing nations; for example, in the EU, the company have to comply with the GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) and GDPR imposes strict rules on the information management as well as privacy (Reid *et al.* 2023). There, if a company is failing to comply and adhere to these types of regulations and laws, then it can result in substantial fines as well as damages to the reputation of the company. There, specifically in the US, the company has to navigate the Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA) of the US; it mandates stringent anti-corruption measures. Thus, these regulatory frameworks demand a robust compliance strategy for avoiding the legal pitfalls of a company like GSK and also ensure smooth operations.

Another critical area of focus for the company GSK is market expansion; there, the growth strategy of the company involves entering new markets as well as ensuring expansion of its footprint in existing ones. This process is fraught with challenges and that include selection of right markets, determination of the most effective entry modes as well as adaptation to the local market conditions; the company GSK can be found critically employs a range of market strategies which include exporting, wholly owned subsidiaries as well as joint ventures, and all these strategies also has its own set of risks as well as advantages (Kim *et al.* 2021). In consideration to the strategy ensured by the company GSK, choices of a specific strategy can be ensured that essentially depends on a range of factors which are included with regulatory landscape, competitive environment as well as market potential.

There, the competitive positioning as well as operational efficiency of GSK is also significantly impacted by the global market dynamics; regarding this, economic disruptions, technological advancements as well as geopolitical conflicts are some of the most critical factors which play a critical role in shaping the international business environment. Examples in this aspect can be economic downturns in key markets, which can affect the profitability and revenues of the company GSK, there geopolitical tensions can also disrupt market access along with supply chain management process (Latham *et al.* 2020). There, on the other hand technological advancements for the company presents both opportunities and challenges, that is because technological advancement can lead towards innovation as well as improved efficiency ut aso they also necessitates continuous investment as well as adaptation for staying competitive.

Along with that, the main consideration of this study, the risk management is a critical aspect of the global operations of GSK; there, the organization faces a range of risks that includes regulatory risks, market risks as well as operational risks. The market risks can be found are related to the changes in the market condition such as shifts in consumer preferences, economic fluctuations as well as competitive pressure. Moreover, regulatory risks arise from the necessity of complying with diverse as well as evolving regulations across diverse markets. Lastly, the operational risks essentially involve disruptions in supply chains, distribution networks as well as production processes (Reid *et al.* 2023). There, the company GSK can be found employs an in-depth and in-detailed risk management framework towards identifying, assessing as well as mitigating these risks and this framework includes strategies such as diversification, the usages of advanced technologies as well as strategic collaborations.

Overall, it can be suggested that understanding the strategies of GSK for regulatory compliance, risk management and market expansion provides valuable insights into the challenges as well as opportunities that are faced by multinational enterprises in the healthcare sector. Now, through the examination of these identified aspects, the study aims to contribute to the body of knowledge on international business operations as well as risk management practices.

1.3 Problem Statement

In consideration of the problem statement, it can be suggested that despite the global structure and extensive experience of the GSK, the company faces significant challenges in regards to the maintenance of regulatory compliances, and not only that but also achieving market expansion as well as managing risks across its international operations. There, the varied regulatory environments and stringent regulations in different nations pose ongoing compliance challenges, and each region has its own set of standards and rules which the company GSK have to adhere to that can be not only resource intensive but also a complex process too (Tulum *et al.* 2022). As suggested before, non-compliance with these considerations can result in hefty fines, reputational damage as well as legal battles that underscore the necessity for an adaptable and robust compliance strategy. Moreover, it also can be found that market expansion is another area where the company GSK encounters challenges; in this aspect, entering new markets as well as expanding in existing ones demands a comprehensive understanding of local market conditions that includes consumer preferences, competitive landscapes as well as regulatory requirements

(Munyalo, 2020). There, the selection of appropriate market entry strategies is pivotal towards the success of these expansion efforts. Although, each strategy-whether it is exporting, joint venture, franchising, or wholly owned subsidiaries; and these also come with its own set of risks as well as rewards. Now, the dynamic and evolving nature of global markets means that the company must continuously adapt its strategies towards remaining competitive as well as capitalizing on growth opportunities.

As suggested before, risk management is a critical aspect of the strategy of GSK, after that also risk management has its own set of challenges; there, the company has to identify, assess as well as mitigate a wide range of risks associated with its international operations. Now, as identified before regulatory risks, market risks as well as operational risks each demands tailored mitigation strategies; for instance, regulatory risks can be managed through in-depth and in-detailed compliance programs as well as regular audits, where market risk also demands diversification song witn strategic partnerships (Mendoza *et al.* 2024). There, operational risks, such as disruption in supply chain demands a robust contingency planning along with frameworks of critics management. There, another layer of complexity for GSK is as suggested global market dynamics, here factors like economic disruptions, rapid technological advancements as well as geopolitical tensions can significantly impact the competitive positioning and operational efficiency of the company. There, the demands of GSK's products can be significantly reduced at the time of economic downturn and geopolitical conflicts can not only disrupt supply chain but also limit market access (Kim *et al.* 2021). Furthermore, staying abreast of technological advancements demands continuous investment in research and development along with that adoption of new technologies towards new technologies for enhancing innovation and operational efficiency.

1.4 Research Aim and Rationale

Aim

The aim of the study will be to analyze the international business operations of GSK which focuses on market expansion strategies, risk management, regulatory compliances and other similar considerations for understanding the challenges as well as opportunities in the global pharmaceutical sector.

Rationale

In consideration to the rationale for this study, it can be suggested that understanding the strategic approaches as well as risk management practices of GSK is pivotal for identifying the effective methods towards navigating the complexities of global markets (Williams *et al.* 2021). This study critically provides valuable insights into the best practices for the multinational enterprises like GSK that helps them in achieving sustainable growth, competitive advantages as well as operational efficiency in diverse regulatory and market environments.

1.5 Research Questions and Objectives

1.5.1 Research Questions

The research questions for the study are provided below:

- *RQ1: What are the regulatory compliance measures that are adopted by GSK in different nations?*
- *RQ2: What are the market expansion strategies of GSK along with their effectiveness in diverse global markets?*
- *RQ3: What are the impacts of global market dynamics on the competitive positioning and operational efficiency of GSK?*
- *RQ4: What are the risks that are associated with international operations of GSK and their mitigation strategies?*

1.5.2 Research Objectives

The objectives of this study are provided below:

- *RO1: To evaluate the regulatory compliances measures that are adopted by GSK in different nations*
- *RO2: To analyze the market expansion strategies of GSK along with their effectiveness in diverse global markets*
- *RO3: To assess the impact of global market dynamics of the competitive positioning and operational efficiency of GSK*
- *RO4: To investigate the risk that are associated with international operations of GSK and their mitigation strategies*

1.6 Methodological Overview

First and foremost an interpretivism philosophy is adopted in this study for understanding the nuanced as well as subjective aspects of the international operations of GSK; there, an explanatory research design is employed for exploring the causal relationships between regulatory compliance, risk management practices as well as market expansion strategies (Souza *et al.* 2020). Furthermore, for data collection; here, a secondary qualitative data collection is ensured which involves analyzing existing literature, company reports as well as industry publications. For analysis of the collected data here a thematic data analysis process is ensured.

1.7 Research Significance

This research study is highly significant in the academic and business environments, as it has mainly delivered a cohesive knowledge and understanding related to international business operations and risk management approaches adopted and used by modern companies like GlaxoSmithCline (GSK) in the pharmaceutical industry while navigating global business dynamics and complexities. As stated by Uzougbo *et al.,* (2024), it has also been found that how an international company can maintain regulatory compliance measures, expand markets across unique geographical locations, operational risks and challenges faced with mitigation have also been understood throughout this study. As the modern business landscape has been impacted higher due to globalization, relevant and latest information can also be gained from this specific research context, whereas future academic researchers have also been benefited from the same study of research. It can also be stated that theories and models/frameworks applied in this research can also be used in the real business contexts by numerous pharmaceutical industry players further (Ajala, 2023). In addition to this, from the literature gap of this study, this study has also worked in depth for revealing more viable insights and nuanced perspectives that are relevant to the topic matter the most. Business leaders and policymakers have also benefited from this research study with practical insights gained.

1.8 Research Structure

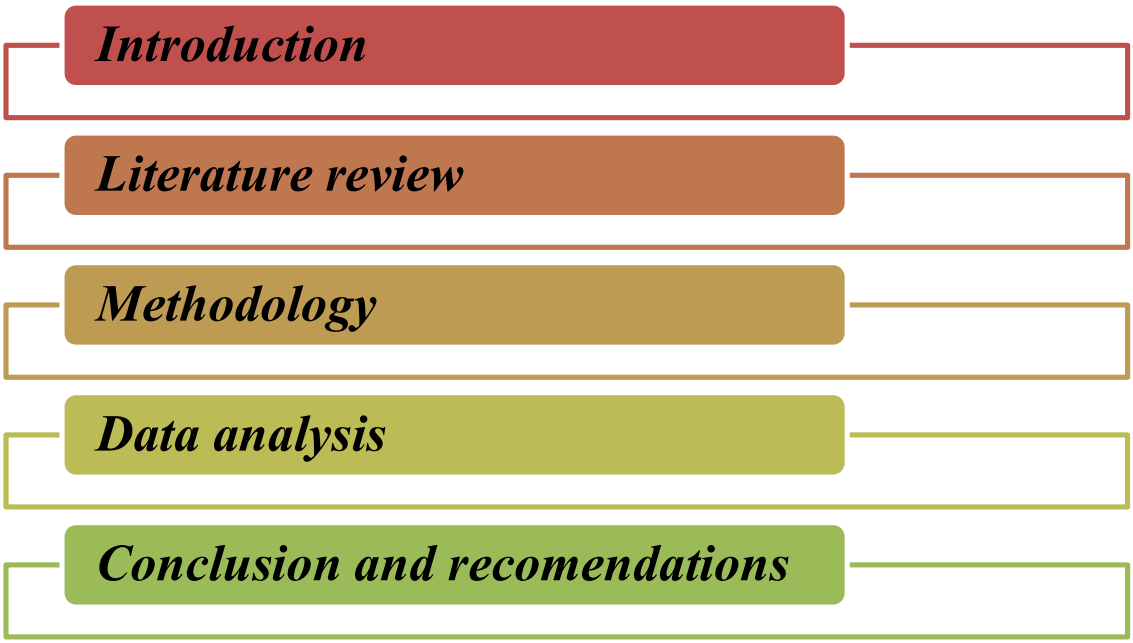


Figure 1.1 Research structure

(Source: Created by the author)

The study is divided in 5 main sections, and the first section or introduction or this section provides an overview of this subject as we as sets the stage for this study with defining aim and objectives for the subject. Moreover, the second section or literature review ensures a comprehensive understanding about the subject with literature gaps as well as theoretical considerations for this subject (Bhattacharyya and Naser, 2020). Then comes the methodology which ensures the methods and techniques followed for the development of this subject, this section along with describing the ethical considerations also justifies the selection of the methods and techniques. Then comes the analysis and discussion section which assures the thematic analysis about the data collected for the development of the subject, and these themes are ensured as per the objectives and aim of the study. Lastly, conclusions and recommendations ensure the overall overview of this subject.

1.9 Chapter Summary

From the above discussion, it can be suggested that this chapter introduced the focus of the study on international business operations as well as risk management practices of GSK. There, it

outlined the research background, problems statement, research aim and rationale and other considerations which essentially set the foundation for a comprehensive analysis in subsequent chapters.

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Chapter Introduction

Global business organizations have acquired both opportunities and challenges due to complex international business operations. That is why it has also been stated that for handling this complex web of global business and market landscape, the need and demand for risk management and strategic frameworks have been highlighted the most (Uzougbo *et al.,* 2024). Throughout this chapter, it has been critically reviewed and evaluated the regulatory compliance measures for different countries across international business operations, market expansion measures with their effectiveness across diversified global marketplaces, global market dynamics and its impact on competitive positioning and operational effectiveness, and risks connected to global business activities with mitigation solutions.

2.2 Regulatory Compliance Measures adopted across different Nations for International Business Operations

For ensuring seamless business operations, it has also been needed to make regulatory compliance, whereas strategic and legal frameworks have played diverse roles under varied jurisdictions. It has also been identified that in the field of legal business, major complexities have emerged due to its difficult nature, variations, cultural differences, financial scenarios of different countries, and others. As mentioned by Nzeako *et al.,* (2024), global business organizations should handle and tackle such complexities for ensuring functional effectiveness equipped with enhanced means of legitimacy after all.

On the other hand, it has also been denoted that for adopting and using the right regulatory compliance measures, it has also been needed to maintain the right laws and standards, which might be varied from countries to countries (Nzeako *et al.,* 2024). For example, it has been seen that data management has been considered an integral part for companies operating in Europe, otherwise it might cause huge fines. That is why, the European Union's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) has mainly enacted stringent rules and regulations for managing and storing data systematically. It has also been indicated that in the business context of the US also, *the U.S. Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA)* has also imposed several rules and guidelines for companies, through which they have also become able to manage business internally with right

legal compliance by benefiting from strict anti-corruption measures thereafter (Salguero-Caparrós *et al.,* 2020).

From another point of view, it has also been explored that apart from maintaining regional business rules and guidelines, several international standards should also be needed to be maintained by international companies. As reported by Salguero-Caparrós *et al.,* (2020), *the International Organization for Standardization (ISO)* has mainly delivered a universal platform for all companies, who can streamline their core business operations and activities in the market systematically. For instance, *quality management (ISO 9001)* followed by *environmental management (ISO 14001)* have also been highlighted the most. It has also been argued that apart from enhancing and ensuring functional effectiveness of these business entities or bodies, such standards have also played pivotal roles to maintain competitive position in the market by gaining competitive advantage after all (Pererva *et al.,* 2021).

Regarding this matter, it has also been denoted that for modern business organizations, key *compliance management systems (CMS)* must be necessary to maintain and control, whereas the need and demand for adhering to the right legal standards has been justified higher. In the overall risk management framework, there must also be a need to embed the system of integrated legal compliance measures and systems, through which all of these same business organizations have also become able to handle as well as manage potential business risks accordingly (Pererva *et al.,* 2021). It has also been found that CMS has also played a vital role in terms of increasing the core business levels of clarity as well as social responsibility, through which it becomes also possible to prevent and avoid the chance of security data breaches and control further.

Now, it has also been identified that, mainly due to the vibrant and volatile aspect of international business, rules and guidelines have also needed continuous means of supervision and control. According to Contractor *et al.,* (2020), it has also been argued that necessary adjustments might be needed wherever it has become applicable against sudden changes in the regulatory landscape embodied with compliance needs and systems. In addition to this, it has also been stated that this hands-on approach has also played a vital role to embed and use the right legal compliance properly in this dynamic environment. It has also been stated that if these legal compliance cannot be used or maintained properly, most business organizations might face financial or business risks, which might also be leading towards image loss of businesses causing security data breaches or other accidents (Contractor *et al.,* 2020).

From a critical perspective, it has also been said that for modern business organizations, strategic collaborations with local community agencies as well as industry agencies has also been necessitated, whereas right legal compliance has also played pivotal roles. Concerning this fact, it has also been said that as the whole business regulatory landscape is quite complex in nature, these strategic business collaborations have played vital roles for companies to gain viable insights and nuanced perspectives for making their core business activities smoother and seamless in the whole market segment (Jackson *et al.,* 2020). Besides that, strategic collaborations with different kinds of industry bodies by these same organizations has also enabled the same to maintain the right regulatory standards and principles, which has also mandated favorable regulatory business environments in the future.

Furthermore, it has also been denoted that though regulatory compliance is necessary for international companies, there are also several challenges and issues that might be faced by these same business bodies while the process of incorporation and usage. As indicated by Jackson *et al.,* (2020), it has also been argued that as the expense of legal compliance is quite higher, other expenses connected to hiring legal counsel, training and development, CMS implementation, and others should be managed and handled wisely. In one word, it is important to say that mainly due to the complex landscape of these regulatory business systems and frameworks, global business organizations might face challenges and issues, whereas financial loss and operational hurdles might also be expected thereafter (Alon *et al.,* 2020). Though the regulatory compliance measures have induced major challenges and issues, several opportunities of business have also underlain in the same field. Modern business organizations should handle these same challenges and issues for acquiring competitive edge from the marketplace.

2.3 Market Expansion Strategies and Effectiveness in Diverse Global Markets

In this modern business and market landscape, it has been identified that major companies have mainly tended to expand their existing business operations following sustained growth and development. In this matter, the need for feasible market expansion strategies have become higher. It has also been stated that for making a market expansion strategy for a company successful, several valued aspects should be maintained in the same context of the market. Those have consisted of regional business scenarios, market selection and penetration strategies, entry modes, and others (Alon *et al.,* 2020). That is why; viable insights and nuanced perspectives

should be gained and nurtured for making productive and insightful market expansion for modern business organizations accordingly.

On the other hand, it has also been stated that before making market expansion for a business entity, it is necessary to select the market segment first. That is why, in this case also, several integral elements such as market size, business opportunities lie in the market, competitive environment, regulatory landscape, growth capacity, and others have been highlighted the most (Gillespie and Swan, 2021). It can also be stated that according to the eclectic paradigm, which has mainly been introduced by John Dunning, has mainly highlighted the core significance of ownership, location, as well as internalization (OLI) advantages and opportunities while selecting a feasible market segment on behalf of a modern business organization. In detail, the aspect of *ownership advantage* has mainly been defined as how a company has acquired its intellectual business assets or properties, which have been considered as technological advancements, brand value in the market, and others (Gillespie and Swan, 2021). However, *internationalization advantage* has mainly been considered as a company's capability of handling as well as controlling internal business operations and activities rather than through external strategic business collaborations or engagements in the same field thereafter.

From another point of view, it has also been said that after selecting the feasible marketplace for expansion of business further, the market entry mode should be selected plausibly. In this case, it has also been highlighted that for entering a marketplace, there are several modes including franchising, exporting, joint ventures (JVs), licensing, wholly-owned subsidiaries, and others have been highly prioritized (Katsikeas *et al.,* 2020). It has also been said that all of these entry modes have mainly acquired their own advantages and disadvantages. For example, it has also been observed that by exporting products of a company across host nations, lesser risks might be obtained, but most of its business operations have mainly been controlled and managed by other third-parties. However, it has also been argued that in the context of wholly-owned subsidiaries for businesses, higher returns might be expected, but there must also be a need for higher business capital for investment after all (Katsikeas *et al.,* 2020).

Now, it has also been denoted that for making market expansion successful for a modern business organization, several factors and elements should be considered as the topmost priority. Those have mainly involved the host nation's regulatory landscape for controlling business operations in the market, the company's available business resources, nature of product or

service, and others. As stressed by Edeh *et al.,* (2020), it can also be stated that the entry mode related to wholly-owned subsidiaries has mainly been accepted by those companies, which have mainly acquired substantial resources for gaining sustainable competitive advantage (SCA) from the market. However, it has also been argued that other entry modes of market such as JVs or strategic alliances might be accepted by low resource-enabled business organizations embodied with high business risks, through which they have also become able to share risks and resources with other companies in the market to become successful, productive, as well as profitable in the future after all (Edeh *et al.,* 2020).

Apart from that; it has also been said that for making the process of market expansion for a company successful, there must also be a need for realizing the local business and market conditions fully. In this way, the conflict between adaptation as well as standardization has been highly entertained, whereas standardization approach has mainly argued that for achieving economies of scale across major business operations and activities in the market, uniform marketing and sales strategies have played key roles, which has also helped a lot to increase brand value and loyalty in the same aspect (Paul, 2020). In contrast, through adaptation, it has mainly advocated for personalizing brand marketing strategies of a company, through which it has also become able to fulfill modern demands and expectations of customers in the market, while it has also increased the levels of employee satisfaction and engagement at the workplace at the same time.

Furthermore, it has also been highlighted that adaptation strategies and measures for modern business might be beneficial across numerous contexts. This is because; for major companies, it is highly evident that its high product attributes and cultural preference maintenance have become the key to ensure long-term business success with profitability. As advocated by Paul, (2020), for gaining international business success also, it has been suggested to consider and deliver enhanced respect towards local traditions and values thereafter. Strategic business collaborations and channeling have also been considered valuable business strategies to make the process of market expansion successful. It has also been justified higher that for gaining viable insights and nuanced business perspectives also, strategic business collaborations should be made (Vătămănescu *et al.,* 2020). In this way, modern business organizations can increase their distribution potential higher, whereas right legal compliance should be made as per the right rules and regulations in the same business context.

2.4 Impact of Global Market Dynamics of Competitive Positioning and Operational Efficiency

In this case, it has also been emphasized that for making international business organizations successful and productive in the whole marketplace, international business dynamics has played a key role. In addition to this, it has also shaped the valued business aspects connected to functional effectiveness as well as competitive positioning in the market accordingly (Vătămănescu *et al.,* 2020). It has also been found that in several business cases, there must also be a need for enhanced means of business agility followed by resilience, as several negative aspects including economic disruptions, geopolitical conflicts, and advanced innovation and technology options have induced major impacts. In this way, viable insights and nuanced perspectives have also been gained for stating how modern business organizations can avail competitive edge from the market equipping functional efficiencies in that same business and market context at the same pivotal point (Bayighomog Likoum *et al.,* 2020).

On the other hand, it has also been said that most business organizations have become unable to maintain their competitive position in the market mainly due to economic disruptions. These have mainly occurred due to fluctuations in cost inflation rates, price exchange rates, and others. For example, it has also been seen that due to sudden changes in the exchange rates, most companies which have mainly depended on their export of products have been affected in terms of profit gains and net income. As said by Bayighomog Likoum *et al.,* (2020), it has also been suggested to deploy and use proper hedging techniques and measures with the key purpose of resolving such potential risks connected to economic disruptions and errors in the whole marketplace. It has also been emphasized that several kinds of economic tools like forward contracts as well as options have also safeguarded current movements for stabilizing cash flow and movements in the same business arena (Bayighomog Likoum *et al.,* 2020).

From another viewpoint, it has also been explored that competitive positioning of a company in the market has also been affected through advanced innovation and technology options, which have mainly helped a lot to bolster functional effectiveness of business in the market. For instance, it has been observed that a wide array of technologies and innovations such as artificial intelligence (AI), AR/VR, internet of things (IoT), big data, predictive analytics, cloud computing solutions, and others have mainly helped a lot to streamline major business operations and activities in the market across different industrial settings and landscapes (Hristova, 2021). It

has also been denoted that with the help derived from enhanced levels of automation across major business activities, supply chain networks can also be optimized, whereas data-oriented informed business decisions can also be adopted and used in the same business and market contexts. For instance, it has also been found that successful integration and application of AI in the field of product development scenario has also brought in major growth and developments in terms of overall means of business profitability as well as quality management (Hristova, 2021). In this way, it has also become able to make strong competitive positioning in the market followed by competitive edge in the modern international business and market landscapes.

Apart from that; it has also been denoted that *geopolitical developments* such as through different kinds of trade schemes, global business relations, as well as political instability have also induced negative impacts in the field of international business and market landscapes. It has also been indicated that mainly due to complex tariff, trade barriers and constraints, as well as others have mainly affected the whole competitive environment of business in terms of accessing the whole marketplace and expenses required for ensuring continuous means of business operations and activities (Adama and Okeke, 2024). It has also been said that mainly due to *the US-China trade war*, major taxes have mainly been imposed on certain types of products or goods, due to which major modern business organizations have disrupted their existing supply chain networks or systems. As per expected outcome, they have also been seeking to explore alternative market options available in that same business environment for mitigating that same negative impact as soon as possible. For example, it has also been seen that across several geographical regions of the world such as in several parts of Middle East and Africa, political instability has mainly caused staggered means of business activities. As reflected by Adama and Okeke, (2024), there must also be a need for adopting and acquiring the right and feasible contingency planning and measures for ensuring seamless business continuity and operations thereafter.

Furthermore, it has also been said that in the field of modern business landscape, strategic adaptability and flexibility have been considered integral components. It also helps to handle and manage complex business and market dynamics all over the world. Most companies in the pharmaceutical sector have mainly tended to adapt and use those same business techniques and principles for gaining sustainable competitive advantage (SCA) from the whole marketplace (Mikalef *et al.,* 2020). It can also be stated that this kind of adaptability can also be ensured through such a decentralized kind of business hierarchy, which has also played a key role for

empowering regional subsidiary groups of businesses towards making informed decisions as per local market and business scenarios after all. For example, it has also been seen that with the help derived from such a decentralized business approach, several companies have also become able to personalize their product offerings and service deliveries in the market, whereas feasible and right marketing and sales strategies have also been necessitated at the same time towards increasing the level of international business competitiveness and nature (Mikalef *et al.,* 2020).

2.5 Risks associated with International Operations with Mitigation Strategies

Modern business organizations in this global market landscape have been prone to a wide array of potential risks of operations that might also stagger their stability and productivity with profitability. That is why it has also been stated that as these same issues are quite multidimensional in nature, it has also consisted of several areas such as economic, political, functional, and cultural aspects altogether (Gupta *et al.,* 2020). It has also been stated that for handling and tackling these kinds of potential business risks, there must also be a need for adopting and using more cohesive as well as vibrant mitigation plans and principles in the same business and market contexts.

Regarding this matter, it has also been stated that most international companies have been affected badly due to political challenges and issues faced. Those same challenges have mainly arisen due to a wide array of negative elements and factors, like political instability, geopolitical tensions or conflicts, trade barriers or constraints, stringent rules and regulations, complex tax laws, and others thereafter (Gupta *et al.,* 2020). It can also be stated that by making necessary and available business resources nationalized, several issues such as seizure of international business assets, staggered business activities in the market, as well as others have also occurred, which has also caused a huge monetary loss for businesses. For this specific reason, for managing such political risks and loopholes, it has also been suggested to make proper means of business insurance regarding all of its assets, which has also delivered adequate coverage against losses. As argued by Afum *et al.,* (2020), it has also been stated that with the support derived from a diversification strategy or measure successfully, profitable means of business investments can also be ensured and made that has also played a major role to prevent and avoid the negative consequences of political instability in the host country. It has also highlighted the core significance of geopolitical diversification in the area of risk management and control.

Concerning this fact, it has also been denoted that several kinds of economic risks might also emerge in the same field. Those have mainly consisted of sudden changes in exchange rates, volatile price fluctuations, cost inflation rate changes, and others, which have also staggered major international business operations badly. Those companies which have mainly tended to procure a stabilized economic planning and measures have also been affected badly due to such price disruptions, which has also affected the aspect of business related to FDI thereafter (Afum *et al.,* 2020). It can also be stated that for handling this same challenge and issue, most international business organizations have mainly tended to adopt and use several hedging mechanisms and principles to find out alternative options available that also help to restore those same companies' financial conditions just like before. It has also been identified that sudden changes in the rates of cost inflation might also erode and hamper operational benefits of businesses with staggered profit margins (De Bruin *et al.,* 2020). That is why,most business organizations have mainly tended to make necessary adjustments of pricing mechanisms, whereas in several business cases, proper sourcing can also be made from low cost inflation nations thereafter. Against the issue regarding economic recessions, it has also been proposed to adopt and use several cost-cutting measures and strategies, through which it has also become able to ensure economic stability through a stable workforce following scaling of business operations and activities in the same context (De Bruin *et al.,* 2020). In one word, proper maintenance and control of an adaptable costing regime as well as effective economic surpluses have played major roles to weather economic disruptions and fluctuations better.

Now, in terms of *cultural risks*, it has mainly indicated that mainly due to language differences and customs, these kinds of risks have emerged in the global business and market landscapes. Regional stakeholders engaged in businesses might be dissatisfied due to sudden increase of misunderstandings and misconceptions, which has also been leading towards operational inefficiencies (De Bruin *et al.,* 2020). That is why it has also been found that most global companies have tended to mitigate these kinds of risks through successful promotion of open and inclusive communication practices followed by several cultural training programs. In this way, both expatriates and local employees have also become able to understand the actual meanings of cultural sensitivity and awareness better. Besides that for understanding the regional market and actual needs and demands of customers better, regional managers have also been needed to appoint and hire in the same context (Gurtu and Johny, 2021). Apart from resolving this kind of

risk, the opportunity of market or business expansion has also become fruitful in nature, whereas strategic business collaborations have also been highlighted in the same field. It has also emphasized the valued aspect related to cultural adaptation in shaping long-term success and growth of global business operations and activities better.

In final words, it has also been said that mainly due to lack of technological advancements following supply chain disruptions, operational challenges have also been faced across modern international companies in the market. Mainly most companies have become unable to ensure production on time, as the pandemic hit has mainly hampered most of their existing supply chain networks and systems (Gurtu and Johny, 2021). That is why, against such potential business managerial risks and challenges faced, enhanced means of business resilience and supply chain mechanisms with principles have been highlighted the most to adopt and use in such a systematic manner. Supplier diversification strategies have also been suggested to adopt and use in the same business and market contexts.

2.6 Relevant Theories and Models

The OLI Model/Framework

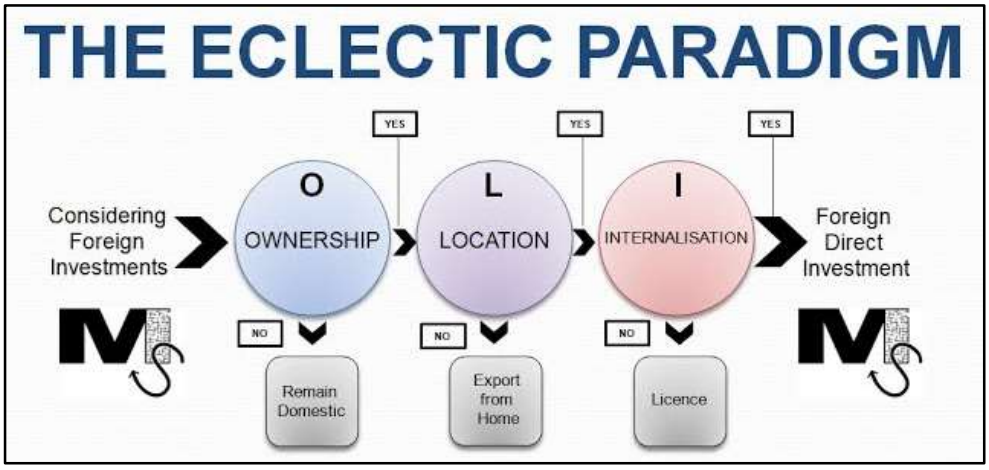


Figure 2.1: The OLI Framework

(Source: Sharma *et al.,* 2020)

This specific model has mainly posited that through three (3) kinds of advantages including location, ownership, and internalization advantages, a company can get competitive edge from the market. This framework has also been emphasized to safeguard and protect an organization's

unique business assets like innovation and brand value, which have also played major roles to gain competitive advantage. As stated by Sharma *et al.,* (2020), in terms of *location advantage*, a company can get business operational benefits from a specific business location or region, which have also been highlighted the most. Furthermore, *internalization advantage* of business has mainly involved a company's potential operations which have also played major roles to manage internal functions, whereas in several cases, external means of strategic business collaborations have also been highlighted the most in the same context. It also helps to manage and reduce excessive business expenses traditionally (Sharma *et al.,* 2020). In one word, this framework has mainly delivered a cohesive knowledge regarding how a company can arrange foreign monetary aid or support, through which global business operations can also be optimized in that same market landscape and business setting after all (Araz *et al.,* 2020).

Institutional Theory

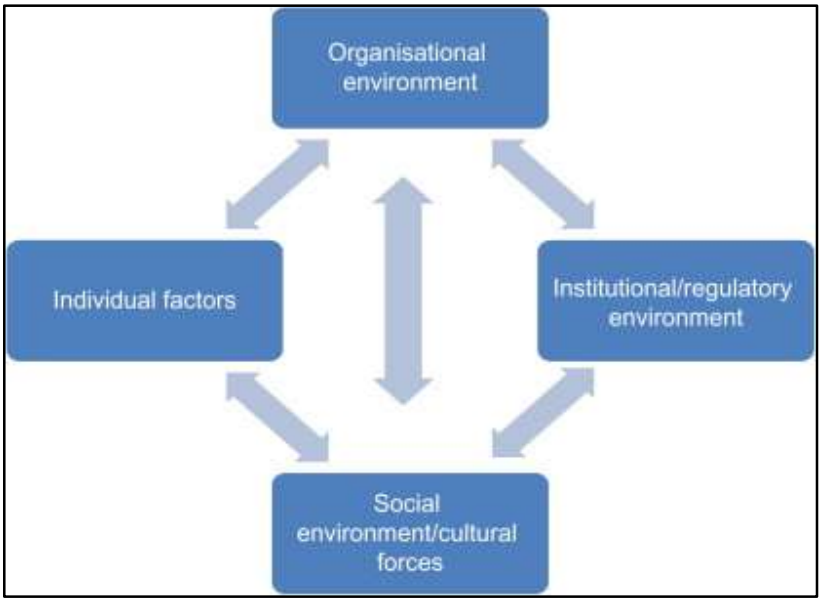


Figure 2.2: Institutional Theory

(Source: McMaster *et al.,* 2020)

In this case, this theory has mainly highlighted that within a host nation, when a foreign company has entered the market, the institutional business landscape has played a pivotal role. According to this theory, it has also been highlighted that all business organizations should conform to the normative, regulatory, as well as cognitive bodies across several countries or nations with the key purpose of availing enhanced means of legitimacy with convenient access to available and

necessary resources (Sharma *et al.,* 2020). It has also been stated that those business entities, which have mainly followed the right regulatory compliance and guidelines have also become able to maintain the cultural and ethical norms of businesses, while cognitive bodies have mainly focused on continuing businesses with shared beliefs as well as values altogether. Furthermore, it has also been denoted that as per this theoretical perspective, most international companies have also become able to minimize and control potential risks and disadvantages that might emerge due to such non-compliance, through which in the regional marketplace, proper means of acceptance has also been highlighted the most (Sharma *et al.,* 2020). In one word, across host countries, for ensuring long-term success of business followed by successful market expansion, it has also been needed to realize the regional taste and preferences or business conditions with actual needs and expectations of customers better.

Contingency Theory

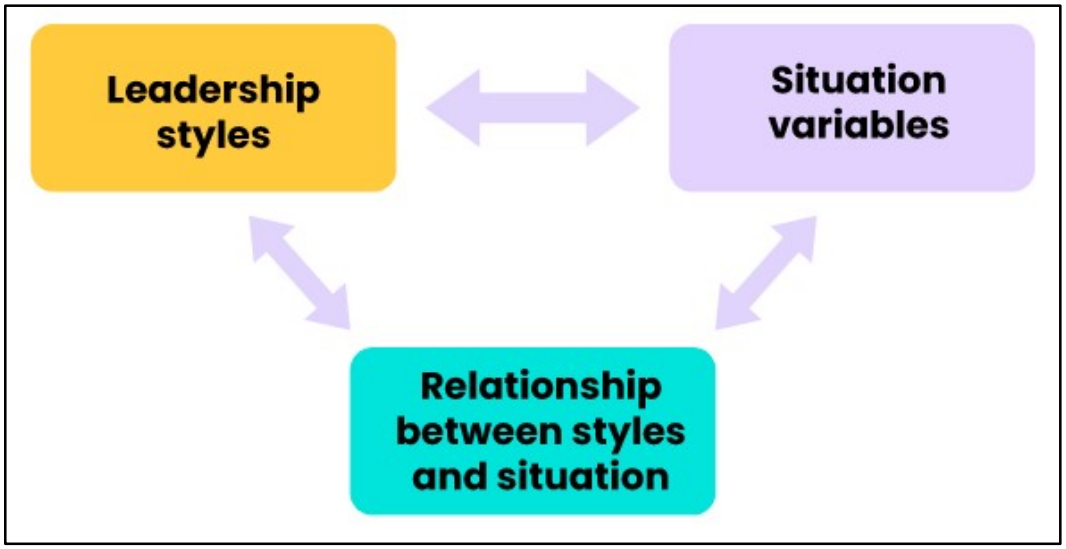


Figure 2.3: Contingency Framework

(Source: Lund *et al.,* 2020)

As a kind of dynamic perception and value, this specific theory has mainly tended to make an international business strategy to become successful and productive through such an one-size-fits-all aspect of business. As mentioned by Lund *et al.,* (2020), it has also been stated that international business organizations should have to adapt the right strategies and business measures based on feasible contingencies, which have mainly consisted of market scenarios, internal business capabilities or potential, competitive market and business dynamics, as well as

others thereafter. The need for strategic adaptability and enhanced market responsiveness has also been highlighted the most after all (McMaster *et al.,* 2020).

2.7 Literature Gap

Though there are several studies related to international business management and risk control from the lens of global market operations, certain gaps might exist. One major gap has been identified as there is a lack of research, which have mainly focused solely on advanced innovation and technology options usage and application in the field of risk management and control across international business operations and market activities. Empirical evidence has been expected rather than theoretical insights, through which it has also become able to understand hands-on insights. In addition to this, there must also be a need for conducting research by focusing higher on cultural awareness and management in the field of international business landscape. This is because; it has been identified that most international companies have faced extreme challenges and issues due to cultural complexity and language challenges, which can also be understood if this research focuses on cultural diversification and awareness training programs that must also deliver mutual respect to all employees of those same companies in the host country and market segment. Moreover, it has also been found that with the help derived from cultural intelligence and potential, potential business management risks can also be mitigated.

2.8 Chapter Summary

It can be summarized that this chapter has mainly highlighted that as the global business and market landscape is quite complex in nature, streamlined international business activities and risk management practices have played major roles in the same field. In detail, it has also been explored that regulatory compliance measures and principles must be necessary for international companies, whereas their market expansion strategy has also become successful through enhanced means of diversification across global marketplaces. It has also been realized that global market and business dynamics have also compelled organizations to maintain their competitive positioning in the market, through which a robust operational efficiency has been ensured.

CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Chapter Introduction

The research methodology section for this study critically serves as the foundation for comprehensively understanding the strategic analysis of international business options and risk management practices of GSK; in this aspect, this section discussed the systematic approach, methods and techniques adopted for conducting this study which assured that the research aim and objectives for this subject are addressed in a critical manner (Pandey and Pandey, 2021). Furthermore, it also needs to be suggested that the section also comprehensively outlines justification for selecting those methods as well. Now, given the complexities involved in regards to global market operations as well as the intricacies involved in risk management process, here an interpretivist philosophy is employed for comprehensively capturing the contextual and nuanced nature of GSK's practices; similarly an inductive approach is considered for critically facilitating the development of insights and theories direct from the information rather than testing f the pre-existing hypotheses (Verma *et al.* 2024). Then, aimed at the elucidating relationship as well as the underlying reasons behind the strategies of GSK and other implementations the explanatory design is also incorporated in this study alongside. Further detailing of these selections is ensured in the bellow section of this chapter, in consideration to this it further needs to be suggested that ethical considerations is also a significant consideration of these types of study as it makes them reliable, dependable and trustworthy, that too is also detailed in this chapter as well. Overall, it needs to be suggested that this methodology section of this study ensures a framework that assures a thorough as well as ethical exploration of the global strategies of GSK.

3.2 Research Philosophy

The underlying theory or the belief system which effectively guide a researcher in the selection of methods, interpretation of information as well as the overall approach towards a study is referred to as research philosophy; there, it needs to be suggested that research philosophy encompasses the nature of reality, the nature of knowledge along with the methods used for acquiring that knowledge (Verma *et al.* 2024). Regarding this, it can be found that there are a range of research philosophical methods can be found that are used by the academics, such as

interpretivism, realism, positivism and others; there, selection or the choice of effective and right research philosophy has a significant influence on the entire research process which stems from the formulation of research questions to the analysis as well as interpretation of the findings (Dubey and Kothari, 2022).

As suggested before for the development of this study, here interpretivism philosophy is considered, this philosophical stance puts a significant emphasis on the understanding of the subjective meaning of social phenomena along with the context in which it occurs. There, the interpretivism philosophy is critically grounded in the belief that reality is not only socially constructed but also that human behavior cannot be fully understood through the measurements of objective alone (Dubey and Kothari, 2022). In consideration to this, instead the interpretivism philosophy seeks towards the exploration of the complexities of human experiences as well as the meanings the individuals attach to them, that often employs qualitative methods for gaining comprehensive insights.

For this study the interpretivism philosophy is adopted also because for the study on the international business operations of GSK as well as its risk management practices aims towards exploring the nuanced as well as complex nature of the strategies of GSK across different global markets that demands an in-depth understanding of the contextual and subjective factors which are critically influencing these strategies (Newman and Gough, 2020). Along with that the approach ensured through the interpretivism philosophy also critically allows for a comprehensive examination of the regulatory compliance measles, and not only that but also market expansion strategies, impacts of global market dynamics as well as risk mitigation strategies at the same time considering the unique opportunities and challenges that are faced by GSK in various regions. Furthermore, this philosophy also critically facilitates the generation of the rich along with qualitative insights from different secondary information sources that enables the development of an in-depth understanding of the practices of GSK as well as their implications (Zhou *et al.* 2022).

Through the adoption of the interpretivism philosophy, the study essentially acknowledges the diversity and complexity of global operations of GSK along with aiming to provide contextual grounded analysis and nuanced analysis of its business strategies along with risk management practices. Thus, it can be suggested that the selection of interpretivism philosophy is effectively justified for this subject.

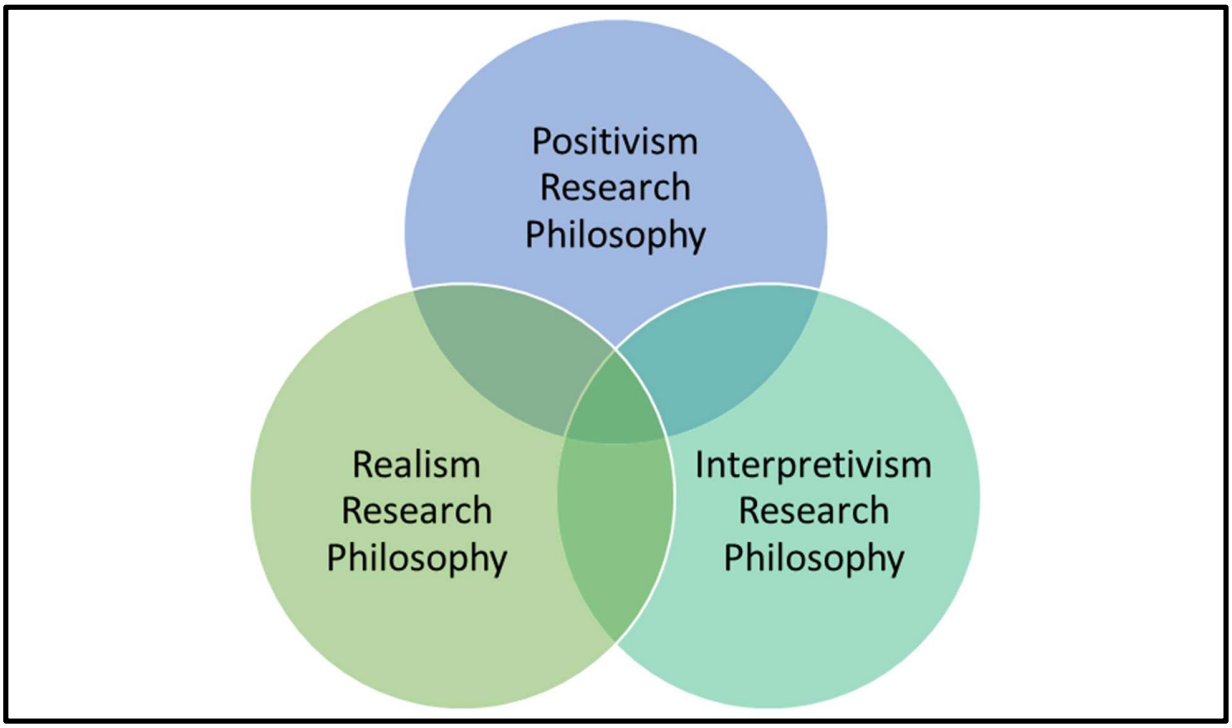


Figure 3.1: Types of philosophical stance

(Source: Zhou *et al.* 2022)

3.3 Research Approach

The plan and procedures for research which spans the steps from broad assumptions to comprehensive methods of data collection, analysis and interpretation is referred to as research approach; there are three research approaches which classified the research approaches ensured by the academics, those are inductive, deductive and abductive research approaches (Ocaña-Fernández and Fuster-Guillén, 2021). Regarding this, an inductive approach critically generates new theories as well as insights on the basis of observed data while the deductive approach tests an existing theory or hypotheses, and the abductive approach is the mixture of these two approaches which are critically used in cases where there is a puzzle or unexplored situation.

For this study, as suggested before here an inductive approach is considered, the inductive approach essentially involves collection of information as well as ensuring the development of a theory as a result of data analysis, thus this approach is a critical and appropriate selection for research which aims towards exploring as well as understanding complex phenomena without

preconceived options that allows the themes and patterns in emerging from the information itself (Dzwigol, 2022).

Now, for the development of this subject, the selection of an inductive approach is justified by the exploratory nature of the research objectives in regard to understanding the international business operations as well as risk management practices of GSK. Thus, the study comprehensively seeks towards understanding the regulatory compliance measures, impacts of global market dynamics, risk mitigation strategies as well as market expansion strategies adopted by the company; with the usages of an inductive approach, the study can effectively develop an in-depth understanding of these practices directly from the information, rather than from a predetermined hypotheses (Dzwigol, 2022). In this aspect, inductive approach is specifically useful for the generation of rich qualitative insights and not only that but also for the identification of new patterns within the existing data which may not have been considered before and thus providing an in-depth as well as nuanced analysis of the strategies of GSK in diovers global markets (Al-Ababneh, 2020). Due to these reasons, the selection of an inductive approach can be critically justified for the development of this subject.

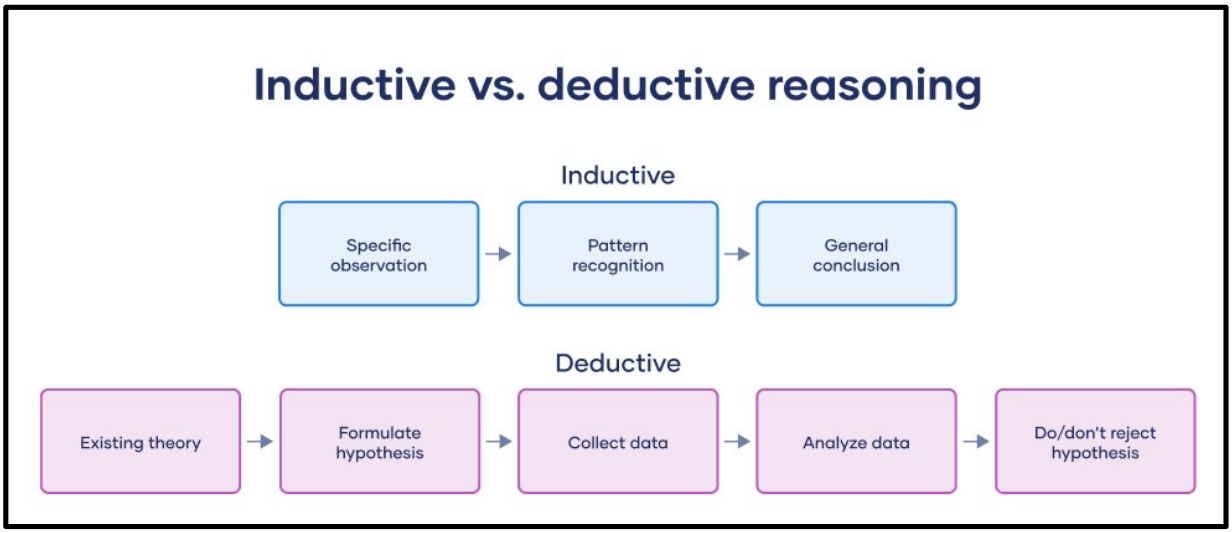


Figure 3.2: Inductive vs. Deductive approach

(Source: Zhou *et al.* 2022)

3.4 Research Design

The overall strategy which a researcher chooses for the integration of the different components of the study in a logical and coherent manner is referred to as the research design which essentially ensures that the research problem is addressed in an effective manner (Mahuika and Mahuika, 2020). Regarding this, it also can be suggested that research design constitutes the blueprint for the collection, analysis and measurement of data along with there are a range of research design can be found such as exploratory, explanatory, descriptive and others there on the basis of the nature as well as objectives of the study, selection of right research design is critical.

Now, as identified before for the development of this study, here an explanatory design is considered which aims towards clarifying the reasoning as well as the way there is a relationship between two or more aspects of a phenomenon and situation. There, explanatory design is effectively used in those studies that critically identify the causes as well as effects of the relationships among the variables (Nayak and Singh, 2021).

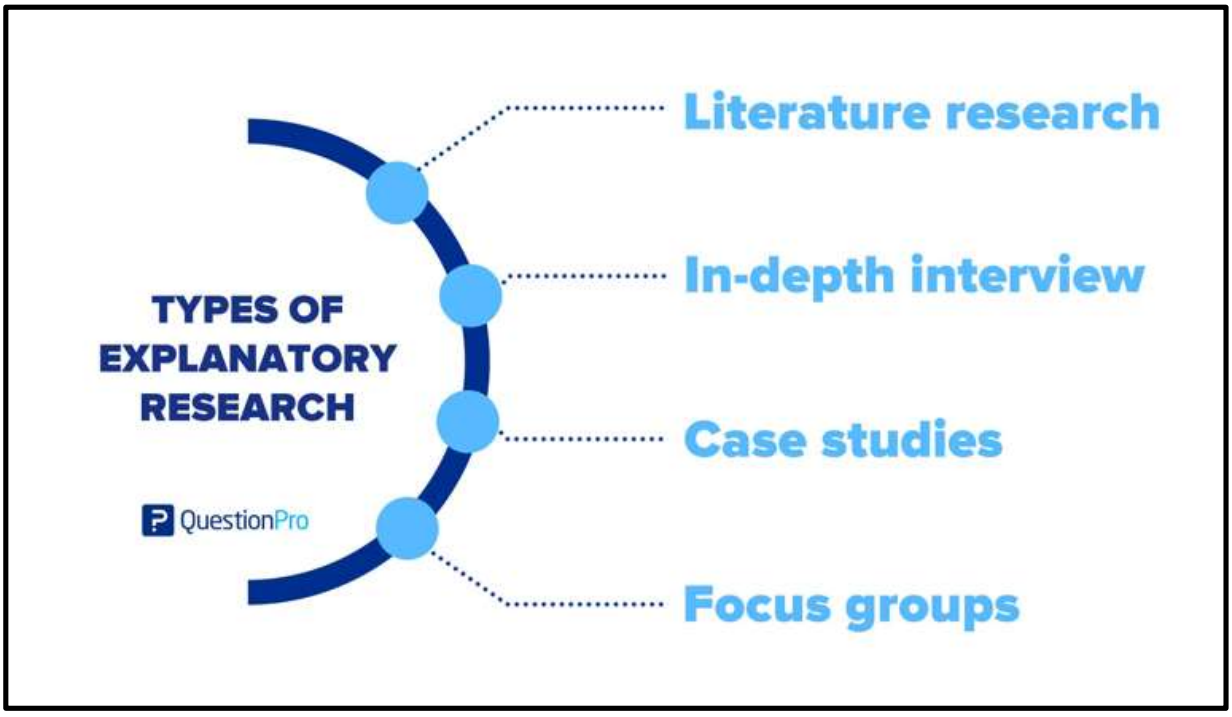


Figure 3.3: Types of explanatory design

(Source: Islam *et al.* 2022)

The choice of an explanatory design for the examination of the international business operations of GSK as well as risk management is critically justified by the necessity of understanding the underlying mechanisms along with casual relationships that are driving the strategies of GSK. The objectives of this study essentially include the evaluation of regulatory compliance measures, the analysis of the market penetration and expansion strategies, the investigation of risk mitigation strategies as well as assessing the impact of global market dynamics; there, the explanatory design is well-suited for effectively uncovering the reasons behind these practices as well as their effectiveness in different situations (Al-Ababneh, 2020). Along with that this allows for a comprehensive exploration of the cause-and-effect relationships within the global operatis of GSK which provides valuable understanding into how and why specific strategies are employed along with their subsequent outcomes (Islam *et al.* 2022). Thus, the selection of explanatory design can be critically justified for the development of this study.

3.5 Sampling

In consideration to the sampling process, it can be critically identified as the ways of collecting information and there are two main ways of sampling process can be found; those are purposive and non-purposive sampling processes (Zou and Xu, 2023). For the development of this subject, here a purposive sampling process is followed, due to the reason through purposive sampling process relevant and reliable information for a subject can be considered which is pivotal for this study. Regarding this, it also needs to highlight that the selection of purposive sampling although ensures selection of only relevant information but it comes with the critical challenges of selection biases. Although, it can impact the dependability and reliability of the study still for mitigating this challenge it is ensured that the data for the subject is selected from a range of sources.

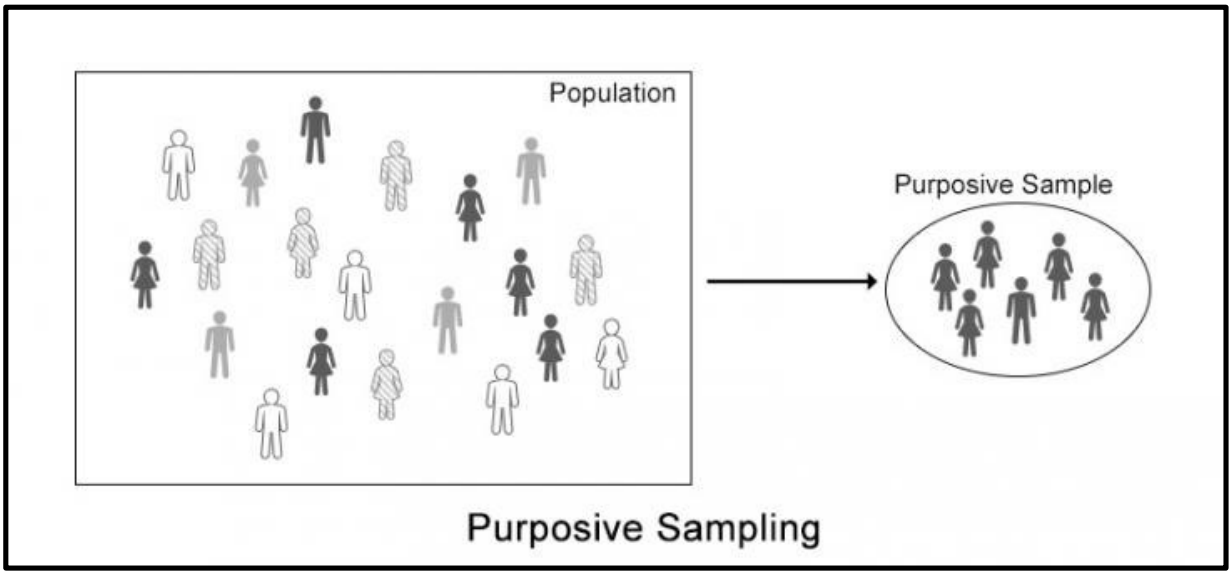


Figure 3.4: Purposive sampling process

(Source: Zou and Xu, 2023)

3.6 Data Collection

For the development of this study, as stated before here a secondary qualitative data collection approach is considered, due to the reason this type of information ensures an in-depth understanding on this subject (Singh, 2022). Regarding this, here information is considered from mainly the online libraries, in this aspect information for this study is considered from libraries like ProQuest, Google Scholar and others, and the sources are in the forms of articles, journals and ebooks. There, not a single source is older than 6 years, due to present market relevance issues. Here, a lot of insights are also considered from online company websites, government reports and others.

3.7 Data Analysis

Regarding data analysis, as here secondary qualitative data collection process is ensured for analyzing those a thematic analysis process is ensured which rightly aligns with the descriptive nature of the objectives of this study (Vebrianto *et al.* 2020). For the implementation of the thematic analysis process a range of steps are applied within this study which are data

familiarization, coding, theme generation, theme defining, theme reconfirmation and lastly writing up of those themes.

3.8 Ethical Considerations

Regarding ethical considerations, it is a critical aspect of a subject that makes it reliable and trustworthy at the same time; due to that for this subject there are different ethical considerations also followed as well. Among them, one of the most critical ones is assuring that the selected secondary information used in this subject has no legal issues related to them such as copyright issues and others (Vebrianto *et al.* 2020). There, during the development of this study for ensuring authenticity of the subject, it is ensured that the study is not plagiarized; moreover the study used cities in an effective manner as well. Furthermore, it also needs to be suggested that the selected information for the development of this subject is not older than 6 years as information older than that has no real relevance with present market due to the reason the recent Covid_19 pandemic as well as turmoil throughout the world because of wars has significantly impacted the present needs, perspectives and preferences within the market (Gupta and Gupta, 2022).

3.9 Chapter Summary

From the above discussion of this chapter, it can be suggested that the selected methods and techniques that are employed for the development of this study can be justified for the development of this subject, as these techniques and methods align rightly with the aim and objectives of this study. Regarding this, it also needs to be suggested that although the selection of the methods for this study is justified but for a greater development of this study as well as to have a more comprehensive and new insights on this subject, the future research needs to consider other methods as well, for instance the selection of primary quantitative data collection for the future studies can provide more detailed understanding of this subject, as through quantitative and primary data personal views on the subject can be ensured along with more recent and updated information as per personal perspectives.

CHAPTER 4: DATA ANALYSIS

4.1 Chapter Introduction

This chapter of the study has mainly analyzed and interpreted gathered data based on articles and journals for understanding the major complexities of global market operations in terms of global business management and risk control practices with a strong emphasis on *GlaxoSmithKline (GSK)*. It has also been highlighted that how global market dynamics has impacted competitive positioning of GSK has also been portrayed in this chapter. Secondary qualitative method-based thematic data analysis method has been applied in this research. Strategic approaches implemented by GSK across diversified business aspects including merger and acquisition (M&A), strategic engagements, investments in the field of R&D have also been emphasized in the same field. In this way, it has also been identified that throughout this chapter, an in-depth account of GSK's business navigation in the international pharmaceutical marketplace has also been demonstrated and evaluated in the same field.

4.2 Secondary Qualitative Analysis - Thematic

4.2.1 Theme 1: Assessing Regulatory Compliance Measures adopted by GSK across Different Nations

Across different countries, based on different contexts of environments, business operations might also be varied in the international pharmaceutical industrial setting including GlaxoSmithKline (GSK). For enhancing brand trust and image positively in the whole marketplace, there must also be a need for maintaining the right legal compliance, whereas the right business standards have also been needed to maintain at the same time.

In the pharmaceutical industrial landscape, the need for clarity followed by self-regulation has been justified. In this aspect, regulatory compliance has also been necessary. As investigated by Mulinari *et al.* (2021), across modern pharmaceutical organizations, the need and demand for self-regulatory principles has been highlighted the most, through which major kinds of disruptions have also been handled including GSK. From this article, it has also been exposed that with the help derived from self-regulation practices, most healthcare practitioners can maintain their right work standards and measures with expected benefits and advantages

thereafter. In the business context of GSK, right compliance measures and actions have played major roles to build the right and productive self-regulatory models as per varied country guidelines and principles.

As stated by Ozieranski *et al.* (2023), especially in the country contexts of the UK and Japan, adequate clarity has helped a lot to maintain the right disclosure practices. In this regard, it has also been indicated that in terms of implementing and adopting the right self-regulatory measures followed by transparency, different contexts have mainly induced different kinds of implementations. It has also been denoted that in the UK, with the help derived from public regulation, adequate clarity has been highlighted the most, while in Japan, public scrutiny has become scarce in the field of self-regulatory measures. It can also be emphasized that GSK has mainly experienced several challenges, which has mainly consisted of strict public rules and regulations, while in several nations, the need for self-regulation has been highlighted the most after all.

On the other hand, it has also been identified that across developing nations, the regulatory landscape across different global nations has mainly demonstrated both opportunities and challenges. As mentioned by Fisher *et al.* (2022), across major regions all over the world, with the help derived from the right regulatory compliance and measures, overall means of pharmaceutical production can be bolstered as a kind of integral component in the same field. It has also been identified that GSK has also adopted several strategies and techniques across these nations in terms of making strategic collaborations with regional government bodies, through which a strong adherence can also be maintained as per the safety standards and principles. With the help derived from this dual perspective, compliance needs have also been fulfilled, whereas as per the global best practices, overall means of reliability as well as functional effectiveness have been nurtured.

As reported by Berlanda Scorza *et al.* (2022), it has also been identified that against neglected diseases, with the help derived from a strategic framework, vaccines have been developed. In addition to this, it has also portrayed that GSK has mainly been dedicated to maintaining the right legal compliance coupled with strategic collaborations and measures. It has also been denoted that for maintaining regulatory compliance, there must also be a need for sustainable development practices followed by key ethical considerations adopted in the same field. GSK has also engaged across such practices of vaccine development, through which neglected

diseases can also be cured, through which the global health landscape has also been navigated better towards fulfilling global health goals and objectives.

Based on varied global contexts, it has also been identified that GSK's adoption of regulatory compliance measures and practices have also been varied. In the context of Europe, as reported by Mulinari *et al.* (2021), for maintaining regulatory compliance properly, key integral elements have been identified as adequate levels of clarity followed by the right legal standards and measures. In the business context of GSK, it has also been observed that across major global countries, in-depth payment disclosures along with strategic collaborations with the right healthcare professionals have also been highlighted the most for nurturing enhanced levels of trust followed by responsibility thereafter.

However, it has also been argued that in Japan, it has also been highlighted that this country's regulatory environment has played major roles. According to Ozieranski *et al.* (2023), major challenges and issues have been faced in the same field. It has also been denoted that for taking the right compliance measures and actions properly, self-regulatory measures and practices have been highlighted the most, through which public oversight can also be handled in the same field. It has also been observed that due to such major disparities observed, GSK must have also been needed to personalize the right compliance measures and actions as per different regulatory contexts of every nation, whereas the need of self-regulatory practices along with enhanced means of responsibility have been emphasized higher.

Across major developing nations, it has also been found that with the help derived from regional regulatory compliance, the volume of pharmaceutical production has been increased. In this way, it has also become able to fulfill the actual needs of public health as well as diseases with major benefits and advantages. As indicated by Fisher *et al.* (2022), by maintaining stringent rules and regulations, it has also become able to increase the level of regional production potential. GSK has also adopted a proactive aspect, through which strategic collaborations followed by such capacity-development campaigns have also played major roles to maintain the right international health standards and principles followed by regional rules and regulations in the same context with benefits and advantages.

4.2.2 Theme 2: Market Expansion Strategies and Measures of GSK with Effectiveness across Diversified International Markets

In this case, it has also been emphasized that for ensuring successful and productive market expansion, different kinds of strategies should be applied. As stressed by Schönheit *et al.,* (2020), for ensuring successful and productive means of market coupling, *a model-oriented interpretation* has been justified higher especially in Central Western Europe. Global market dynamics has also been highlighted in the same marketplace. With a strong emphasis on the energy marketplaces, it has also been identified that both valued aspects of market coupling as well as strategic adaptation have played pivotal roles for ensuring successful and productive market expansion of GSK. It has also been found that a similar perspective has also been deployed and used, through which feasible marketing strategies can be devised depending on the competitive landscape of this same industrial setting (Schönheit *et al.,* 2020). This has also consisted of ensuring standard means of product delivery embodied with enhanced marketing and sales efforts, through which it becomes also possible to fulfill regional needs as well as regulatory needs, which has also ensured that market penetration has also been justified through which functional effectiveness has also been justified.

On the other hand, across diversified marketplaces of Europe, it has also been identified that GSK has also adopted a sound marketing and sales strategy, through which it becomes also possible to maintain the right regulatory compliance and measures, whereas strategic collaborations have also been highlighted with regional bodies. It has also been said that for making the process of market coupling better, unique market needs and demands should be understood, through which GSK can also optimize its existing supply chain management (SCM) system and framework with seamless distribution of products (Schönheit *et al.,* 2020). It has also helped a lot to increase the level of overall market presence by gaining competitive edge from the whole market segment.

Now, in terms of *leveraging global business collaborations*, as advocated by Thorley and Fulda (2020), it has also been highlighted that for ensuring strategic collaboration in China, successful market expansion, growth, and development have also been expected. In addition to this, it has also been said that GSK has also made a strategic collaboration in China, which has also emphasized that this same organization must also be capable of handling such complex regulatory landscapes, whereas local collaborations have also been highlighted the most for

ensuring market access with major benefits and advantages (Grimm *et al.,* 2023). From this same article, it has also been understood that in China, GSK has mainly focused on investing a hefty and profitable amount in the field of R&D and regional production, through which it has also become able to make strong connections with local bodies as well as key stakeholders with the key purpose of ensuring seamless market penetration and expansion with a diverse range of positive outcomes and benefits altogether (Thorley and Fulda, 2020).

Apart from that; it has also been realized that with the support derived from such a kind of leverage-oriented perspective, it has also become able to avoid possible market entry obstacles, through which a sound market presence has also been developed against challenging landscapes. In this field, GSK must also be capable of leveraging its global business skills and knowledge for allocating and using available resources in the whole business landscape. There must also be a need for making a strong adaptation with regional market scenarios, through which enhanced means of business agility can also be achieved (Thorley and Fulda, 2020). Apart from ensuring seamless and hassle-free means of market penetration across new segments, it has also ensured enhanced means of business sustainability followed by sustained growth and development across such diversified marketplaces.

Apart from that; in the case of *Sustainable Growth and Development* through R&D, as advocated by Teramae *et al.* (2020), it has also been evaluated that across major multinational pharmaceutical organizations in the global marketplace, sound R&D perspective has played a pivotal role in terms of ensuring sustainable growth and development. For example, it has also been seen that GSK's strong R&D capabilities have played a major role to ensure seamless expansion across foreign marketplaces, through which further growth and development have also been justified higher along with suitable therapies meeting global health needs and demands. In one word, from this article, it has also been understood that continuous means of investment must also be necessitated in the field of R&D for maintaining and aligning the right means of competitive advantage in the market followed by sustained business growth and development thereafter (Teramae *et al.* 2020).

It can also be stated that GSK has also been dedicated higher to make strategic collaborations with different kinds of agencies, such as educational bodies, research companies, biotech organizations, and others all over the world. It can also be stated that through such effective means of strategic collaborations, GSK has also become able to access cutting-edge innovations

followed by scientific methods and strategies for developing innovative products, therapies, and business solutions (Teramae *et al.* 2020). For meeting unforeseen business circumstances, GSK can expand its product varieties, through which overall means of market presence as well as growth capacity have also been justified higher. Sharma *et al.* (2021) delivered several strategies and measures adopted for exploring unique drugs through which overall R&D productivity has also been increased.

4.2.3 Theme 3: Influence of Global Market Dynamics within Competitive Positioning with Operational Effectiveness of GSK

In this case, it has been highlighted that global market dynamics has mainly induced a positive impact on the field of competitive positioning, through which operational effectiveness has also been increased across major multinational pharmaceutical organizations including GlaxoSmithKline (GSK). It has also been identified that an aesthetically pleasing office design has mainly embraced enhanced levels of productivity with well-being. As highlighted by Marsh and French (2020), for enhancing workplace productivity among employees, an optimized workplace design and principles have played major roles. It has also been identified that GSK's *Workspace Performance Hub* or network has played a major role to build a strategic office design and network, and overall means of functional effectiveness followed by competitive positioning have been nurtured. This network has also nurtured an optimized workplace, through which employee engagement has also been improved embodied with enhanced levels of well-being and creativity, through which overall means of work performance has been improved after all.

On the other hand, it has also been denoted that to gain competitive edge from the market for organizations, better means of talent management and control have also been justified. In this way, an employee-oriented workplace has also been necessitated (Gupta *et al.,* 2023). That is why, a workspace has also been developed, which must also support employee productivity with enhanced health and well-being, through which GSK has also become able to attract a skilled and knowledgeable workforce (Marsh and French, 2020). In this way, it has also enhanced overall means of work productivity with major benefits and advantages.

Now, as denoted by Arshad and Shehzad (2021), it has also been embraced that *mergers and acquisitions (M&A)* followed by *key performance indicators (KPIs)* have been highlighted the

most. That is why, it has also been said that GSK's strategic M&As have played major roles in enhancing its levels of functional effectiveness followed by competitive positioning in the whole marketplace. From this article, it has also been emphasized that major businesses can sustain their growth and development through proper assessment and evaluation of its economic outcomes, followed by increased levels of market share, size, as well as functional potential. In the business context of GSK, M&A has also delivered key opportunities and advantages for integrating technological advancements. In this way, it becomes also possible to ensure seamless market penetration as well as product diversification. It has also been said that across diversified business contexts, complementary strengths and prowess have helped GSK a lot to improve its R&D potential triggering further means of product growth and development in the same context. In contrast, it has also been argued that for major companies, M&A has mainly become successful by relying upon sound integration followed by strategic alignment with rich workplace culture and processes (Arshad and Shehzad, 2021). GSK has also been capable of handling such major integrations through better realization of its anticipated outcomes followed by enhanced means of competitive positioning in the whole market segment.

On the other hand, as suggested by Berlanda Scorza *et al.* (2022), for developing vaccines against neglected diseases, strategic frameworks should be developed. There must also be a need for making strategic collaborations with industries for ensuring sustainable growth and development. GSK has also engaged with several collaborations, which has mainly emphasized that enhanced means of business dedication must consider international health issues by increasing the level of competitive positioning in the market. Moreover, it has also been found that GSK has also become able to improve its R&D capabilities followed by functional effectiveness through effective means of resource allocation and usage in the same environment. There must also be a need for required skills and expertise in the same landscape (Somasundaram *et al.,* 2021). These same engagements have also emphasized establishing innovative business solutions and measures, through which actual medical requirements can also be met (Berlanda Scorza *et al.* 2022). In this way, it becomes also possible to acquire unique market opportunities and advantages with enhanced levels of profitability in terms of net income and revenue earnings thereafter. Strategic proper alignment with the international health aims and objectives, GSK has also become able to increase the level of its brand image and value in the market following competitive positioning in the pharmaceutical landscape.

As opined by Teramae *et al.* (2020), it has also been indicated that across major multinational pharmaceutical organizations all over the world, improved R&D potential has mainly ensured sustained growth and development. In the business context of GSK, it has also been identified that its R&D segment has been considered a major driver for ensuring competitive positioning with functional effectiveness. That is why, in this same field, profitable investment must also be necessary for improving R&D capabilities, whereas product innovation and diversification have also been highlighted the most. From this article, it has also been understood that in the pharmaceutical landscape, sustainable development has also induced long-term dedication for improving R&D capabilities. In this way, sudden market changes can also be handled and managed better. GSK has also focused higher on implementing and using cutting-edge technologies and innovation aspects, through which it has also become able to discover new drugs with advanced innovation and technology options (Teramae *et al.* 2020). It can also be stated that by highlighting R&D, GSK might also consider the changing healthcare demands by maintaining its competitive edge in the whole market landscape all over the world. Operational effectiveness has also been impacted through strategic office design and workplace with benefits.

4.2.4 Theme 4: Risks Related to the International Operations of GSK and Their mitigation Strategies

As suggested throughout the study, the company GSK operates in a highly complex as well as dynamic international market which faces a range of risks which can significantly impact the operations of the organization (Dang *et al.* 2020). The risks include mainly due to economic fluctuations, legal and political uncertainties, technological advancements and cultural differences and other factors, thus comprehensively understanding these risks along with ensuring implementation of effective mitigation strategies are pivotal for the maintenance of the competitive edge along with operational efficiencies of the company.

Types of risks

Economic risks: As the company GSK critically operates in multiple nations and due to that it is dealing with different currencies, it can be suggested that exchange rate volatility of those nations can significantly lead towards serious financial loss. Examples in this aspect can be identified in regards to local currency fluctuations; here a stronger local currency can critically decrease the competitiveness of the products of GSK abroad where a weaker local currency can

also significantly increase the costs for the company in regards to its imported materials (Luo *et al.* 2022). Due to this, the company needs to have a great financial forecasting team in order to effectively handle such situations, and reliable forecasting from those teams can enable the company to handle such situations in a collective manner. Furthermore, it also can be found that inflation in various nations also can comprehensively impact the pricing strategies of GSK and not only that it also can have a broad impact on the operational cost of the company as well. Regarding this, it can be found that economic instability for instance recessions can reduce the consumer spending on healthcare products that affects the revenue of the company (Gurtu and Johny, 2021).

Legal and political risks: The organization further needs to navigate a diverse regulatory environment, in order to maintain its competitive edge and legalized operations within different markets. There, sudden changes in the process of drug approval, and not only that but also import and export regulations as well as healthcare policies can critically disrupt the operation management process of the company. For instance, the stricter drug and health policies as well as regulations within the European Union in regards to drug safety can significantly increase the compliance cost of the company along with delaying the product launches of the company at the same time (Settembre-Blundo *et al.* 2021). Furthermore, it is also apparent that policy changes, political unrest along with governmental instability can pose a broad range of risks to the operations of GSK; for instance the changes within the policies of the government in regards to foreign direct investments (FDI) can affect the market entry strategies of GSK.

Technological risks: In today's market of rapid technological advancements, companies like GSK necessitates continuous innovation; there, if an organization fails to keep up with the technological changes within the market it can critically lead towards obsolescence that reduces the competitive advantages of GSK (Eduardsen and Marinova, 2020). Along with that the increasing reliance on the digital technologies, makes the company GSK vulnerable towards cyberattacks; there, data breaches along with cyber threats can compromise sensitive information, damage the reputation of the company and disrupt the operational management process of the company at the same time (Shams *et al.* 2021).

Cultural and social risks: The product offerings and marketing strategies of GSK can be significantly influenced by the societal norms and expectations; for example, differing attitudes towards pharmaceutical products along with healthcare practices can include and impact the

market acceptances as well as product demand of the company (Shams *et al.* 2021). Along with that, operating in a cultural environment can essentially lead to misunderstandings and miscommunications; there cultural differences in business practices, consumer behaviors as well as employee expectations can critically affect the operational efficiency and brand reputation of GSK.

Mitigation strategies

Economic risk mitigations: For managing currency risks, it can be found that GSK uses different financial instruments such as forwards, options as well as swaps; in this aspect, by effective hedging against currency fluctuations, the company can effectively stabilize the cash flows of the company along with that it also can help the company in protecting the profit margins at the same time. Furthermore, as opined by Sharma *et al.* (2020), maintenance of a diverse portfolio of markets and products can help the company in effectively mitigating the impact of economic instability in any single region; thus this diversification ensures that the organization is not overly reliant on one market and thus spreading risks across multiple geographics.

Political and legal risk mitigation: It can be found that the company provides political risk insurance for protecting against losses that are arising from political instability; it is this insurance which covers risks such as expropriation, currency inconvertibility and political violence that essentially provides financial stability and protection. Furthermore, as stated by Eden and Nielsen (2020), the company also has robust compliance programs for adhering to local regulations as well there these programs include employee running regal audits along with the establishment of local compliance teams for effectively managing and monitoring regulatory changes.

Technological risk mitigation: In regards to technological risk mitigation, it needs to be suggested that continuous investment within R&D (Research and Development) programs ensures that the company stays ahead of the technological trends; there, by critically fostering a culture of innovation, the company can adapt to technological changes in an effective manner and not only that but also maintain its competitive advantages and develop new products at the same time (Hohenstein, 2022). Moreover, it also can be found that the company implements advanced cybersecurity protocols for the protection against cyber threats, there these measures

include multi-factor authentication, regular security audits, encryptions, and employee training on cyber security best practices.

Social and cultural risk mitigation: The CSR initiatives of the company rightly aligns with the societal expectations which significantly enhances the reputation of the company; regarding this, by critically engaging in community development projects, supporting local healthcare initiatives along with promoting health awareness, the company not only builds goodwill but also ensures trust among its customer base which is serves (Pananond *et al.* 2020). The company also can be found to provide cultural training programs for its employees for the significant enhancement of their understanding of different culture environments, thus these programs help the employees of the company in effectively navigating cultural differences in an effective manner which improves collaboration and communication (Korbin, 2022).

Overall, it can be suggested that for the success of GSK effective risk management is pivotal within the international market; there, through the identification and mitigation of economic, technological, political, cultural and social risks, the company can significantly enhance its operational efficiency and not only that but also maintain its competitive edge within the global market.

4.3 Chapter Summary

It can be summarized that across major pharmaceutical marketplaces all over the world, GSK has mainly focused on expanding its major business functions and activities across new market segments, whereas its robustness and efficiency have also been highlighted the most. It has also been understood that with the help derived from a strategic design-oriented workplace, employees can deliver their best performance at work, whereas M&As have been considered major indicators, whereas strategic collaborations have also been justified for ensuring sustainable growth and development in the same field. With the help derived from proactive R&D innovations and abilities, competitive positioning of companies have also been strengthened in the whole marketplace with expected benefits and advantages at the same pivotal point.

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 Conclusions

From the discussion of this subject in different sections along with from the analysis of the collected information, it can be suggested that the study has analyzed the complexities of global market operations and risk management practices at GlaxoSmithKline (GSK) in a detailed manner. From those analyses and findings, the study concludes that the robust regulatory compliance measures of GSK across different countries comprehensively enhance its operational effectiveness along with its brand trust (Um and Han, 2021). Regarding this, the market expansion strategies of GSK, specifically through innovation in R&D and strategic collaboration, have critically enabled the company in penetrating diverse international markets in a successful manner. Moreover, the competitive positioning of the company is also bolstered through putting significant emphasis on workplace productivity as well as strategic acquisition and merger. Although, it also needs to be suggested that the organization faces significant risks that include legal and political uncertainties, technological advancements, economic fluctuation and cultural differences (Sun *et al.* 2020). The company mitigated those identified risks through a range of policies and practices which include strategic financial forecasting, regulatory compliance, cultural adaptability and continuous technological innovations. These practices not only helped the company in sustaining its competitive edge but also helped the company in ensuring its operational efficiency in nowadays dynamic international pharmaceutical landscape; there, this strategic analysis showcases the significance of adaptive as well as proactive management practices in the navigation of the complexities of global market operations (Chu *et al.* 2020). Thus, it can be suggested that the study effectively obtained its aim and ensured objectives at the first chapter of this study, which made it reliable and dependable.

5.2 Linking with Objectives

The aim of the study is to evaluate the complexities of global market operations as well as risk management at GSK; there the analysis and discussion ensured has successfully linked to the core objectives of understanding the way GSK navigates its international regulatory landscape, maintaining competitive positioning, mitigation various risks ad expands its market reach. Regarding this, first and foremost, the first objective of this study to examine regulatory

compliance across different nations was comprehensively addressed by showcasing the adherence of GSK towards signet pharmaceutical regulations that critically enhances its brand trust and operational efficiency, and thus the study obtained the first objectives of the study (Chu *et al.* 2020). Then, the second objective of the study has been critically obtained as it effectively delved into the market expansion strategies of GSK, specifically focusing on the investment of the company in R&D and strategic collaboration that rightly aligns with the objective of understanding market penetration tactics of the company. Along with that, the exploration ensured in this study in regards to the competitive positioning of GSK through workplace productivity and strategic acquisition and merges also effectively aligns with the third objective of the study of understanding the way GSK maintains its market leadership (Anand *et al.* 2021). Lastly, the fourth objective of the study of risks identification of the company and its mitigation strategies is also critically obtained through the identification of a range of risks such as economic, legal, political, technological, and social and cultural challenges has a direct tie with that objectives, moreover it also showcased effective mitigation strategies as well.

Overall, it needs to be suggested that the study is linked to the identified objectives and aims in a comprehensive manner which critically provides a detailed understanding of the way GSK effectively manages its global operations as well as risks (Luo, 2022). Thus, these linkages reinforced the significance of adaptive strategies along with robust management practices in effectively sustaining competitive edge within the global pharmaceutical industry.

5.3 Research Implications and Future Scope

For suggesting the research implication for this study, it needs to be suggested that the findings have significant implications for future research in regards to global market operations as well as risks management within the pharmaceutical sector which critically underscores the need of adaptive regulatory compliance, robust risk mitigation practices along with innovative market expansion strategies (Dang *et al.* 2020). Regarding this, the future studies on this subject could comprehensively explore the influence of emerging technologies on these strategies and not only that but also in the evolving landscape of global health regulations and the role of digital transformation in regulatory adherence. Furthermore, future studies also could critically focus on the comparative analysis among GSK as well as other pharmaceutical giants of the industry to

critically identify the industry-wide best practices as well as further refining of risk management frameworks.

5.4 Research Contributions

Regarding the contribution of this study, it can be identified that, the study has comprehensively contributed towards the understanding of strategic approaches of GSK towards global market operations as well as risk management within the pharmaceutical industry which critically showcased the successful adaptation of the company towards the regulatory environments, effective risk mitigation strategies and innovative market expansion techniques (Sharma *et al.* 2020). There, through the analysis of the practices of GSK, the study further provided valuable understanding in regards to the complexities involved in the navigation of international markets as well as for the management of industry specific risks. Overall, it can be suggested that these identified contributions critically serve as a reference for both industry and academia professionals that offers a reliable and comprehensive framework for future research on this subject along with practical implications in the field of global pharmaceutical operations (Sharma *et al.* 2020).

5.5 Research Limitations

Despite providing a comprehensive understanding in regards to the considered subject, this study is not free from its fair share of limitations; there, the first limitation of this study comes from its reliance entirely upon secondary data sources, as those may not fully capture the most recent development along with the internal strategic changes at GSK. Regarding this, it also needs to be suggested that the focus of the study specifically on qualitative analysis can suggest that it potentially overlooked the quantitative aspect of this subject which could offer a more comprehensive and personal viewpoint. Moreover, as suggested by Hohenstein (2022), it also needs to be identified that for the completion of the study there was a limited time and resources available, which can further impact the outcomes of this study, as with more time the study could have provided a more comprehensive understanding on the subject, there availability of more resources could ensure insights into more narrowed down and new insights on the subject. Thus, limited time and resources availability has impacted the outcomes of the study in a significant manner (Chu *et al.* 2020). Furthermore, these identified constraints also may impact the depth

and generalizability of the finding and suggest that there is need for future primary research for the enhancement of the understanding on this subject.

5.6 Recommendations

From the above discussion, here a range of recommendations for the company GSK ensured below for a greater success as well as for the maintenance of it competitive edge:

- First and foremost GSK needs to continuously monitor as well as adapt to the strategies of market expansion, where focusing on localized approaches which significantly cater to the unique preferences and demands can be an effective consideration (Anand *et al.* 2021). For this the company needs to conduct a comprehensive and thorough market research and not only that but also it needs to leverage oca partnership as these can enhance the market penetration capabilities of the company and customer acceptance at the same time.
- There for improving regulatory compliance, the company needs to further adapt to the dynamic and evolving regulatory landscape in different countries; there, the implementation of advanced system for the compliance management purpose can be a significant help for the company in ensuring that the organization remains up-to-date with the latest regulations of the market along with mitigating the risks associated with non-compliance (Eden and Nielsen, 2020).
- The company further need to navigate the complexities of global markets, regarding this the company have to promote cultural awareness as well as sensitivity among its employees; there training programs for the employees which specifically focuses on the cultural intelligence can significantly enhance the effectiveness of cross-cultural communication within the company along with collaboration that lead towards better business outcomes (Pananond *et al.* 2020).
- The company for a greater future success and market share development process needs to further strengthen its global collaboration with international stakeholders which include governments, healthcare practitioners and providers as well as other pharmaceutical companies (Pananond *et al.* 2020). It is this collaborative efforts of the company, which can help it in shaping best practices, improved access to new markets as well as joint ventures at the same time.

- Lastly, similar to the present practices of the company, the company needs to continuously foster innovation and R&D. For this GSK has to continually invest in research and development for staying ahead in this dynamic and competitive pharmaceutical industry (Gurtu and Johny, 2021). For this the company needs to put a significant emphasis on innovation as that can lead towards the development of new products as well as solutions which not only meet the global health challenges and drive market growth but also further ensures the uniqueness of the brand and provide a greater competitive edge.

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Appendices

Appendix 1: Student Self-reflection on performance

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Describe how you have used AT LEAST ONE of the following sources of information to improve this piece of work: **1.) (PREFERRED) Feedback from previous assignment(s). This can be from the same module or from a previous module or previous year of study (e.g. comments from 1st year lab formal reports should be used to help improve your 2nd year lab formal reports).** **2.) The marking criteria or rubric provided for this assignment.** **3.) The Department Technical Writing Handbook for Students.**
I first and foremost, utilised the marking criteria provided for this assignment for ensuring that I have met all the key requirements critically, specifically in areas such as critically analysis, referencing and coherence. There, through rightly aligning my work with these criteria, I was essentially able to focus on specific element which contributes towards a higher grade. Along with that, I also continuously followed the handbook provided as well, as that helped in understanding the clear guidelines on structuring my work and not only that but it also helped me in using appropriate academic language and adhering to the formatting standards. Thus, this combination of marking criteria with the technical handbook helped me in improving the clarity, professionalism as well as overall quality of my assignment.
Are there any aspects of this work that you would specifically like the marker to comment/or advise on?For example: "I wasn't sure if my figure formatting looked professional and would appreciate feedback on this aspect"
I would appreciate feedback on the depth of my critical analysis and whether it effectively supports my arguments. Additionally, I would like to know if the structure of my work is logical and coherent, as I aimed to present my ideas in a clear and organized manner. Any advice on improving these aspects would be valuable.

Appendix 2: Plagiarism statement

Plagiarism Statement

I certify that the work submitted is my own and that any material derived or quoted from the published or unpublished work of other persons has been duly acknowledged.

Student Full Name: Vishwa Murugesan

Student Registration Number: 229058491

Signed:_____

Date:_____

By signing that you agree to abide by the University Regulations at registration, you have acknowledged your understanding of the regulations relating to examination offences, plagiarism and collusion. Work that is handed in without this section being signed will receive no mark until you have signed it.